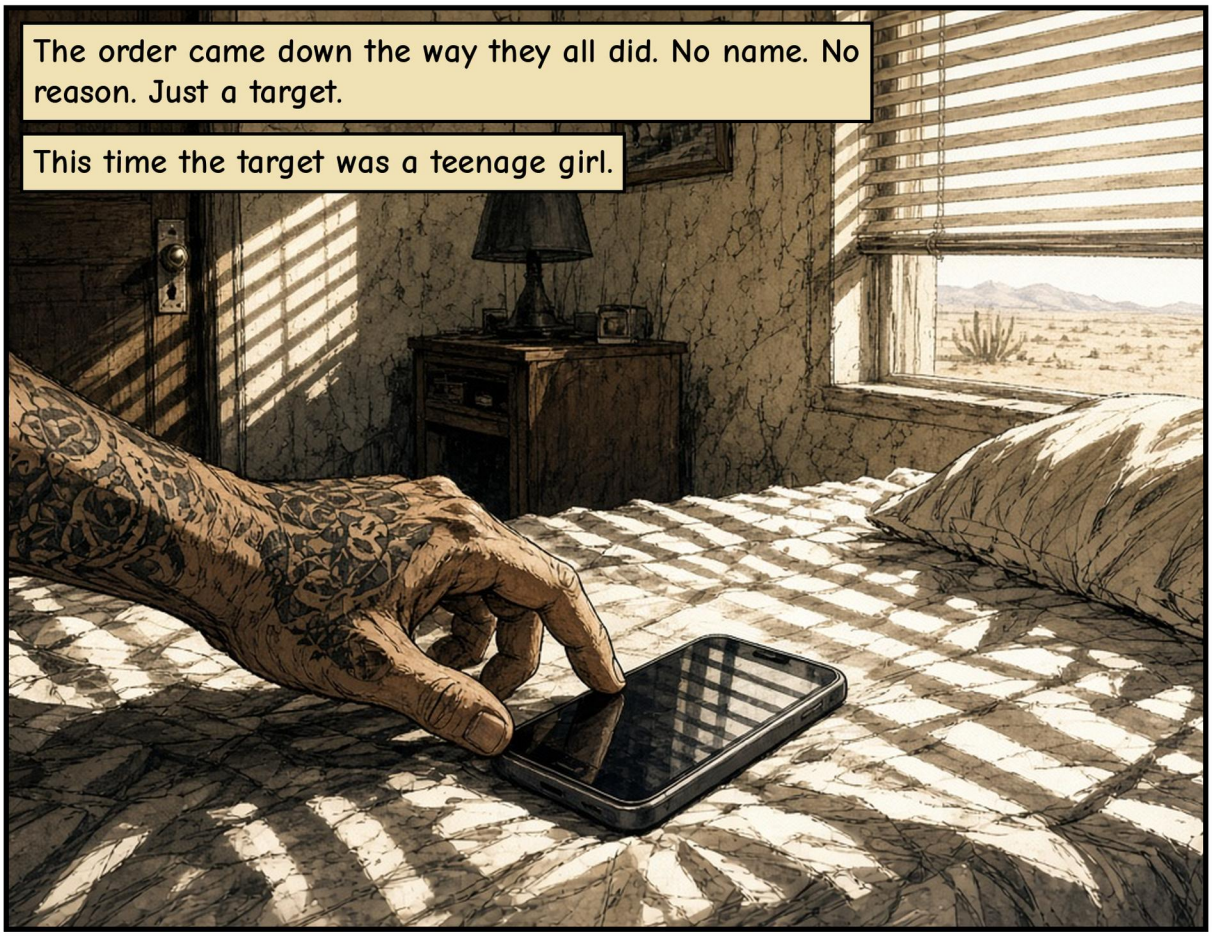
SOLACE

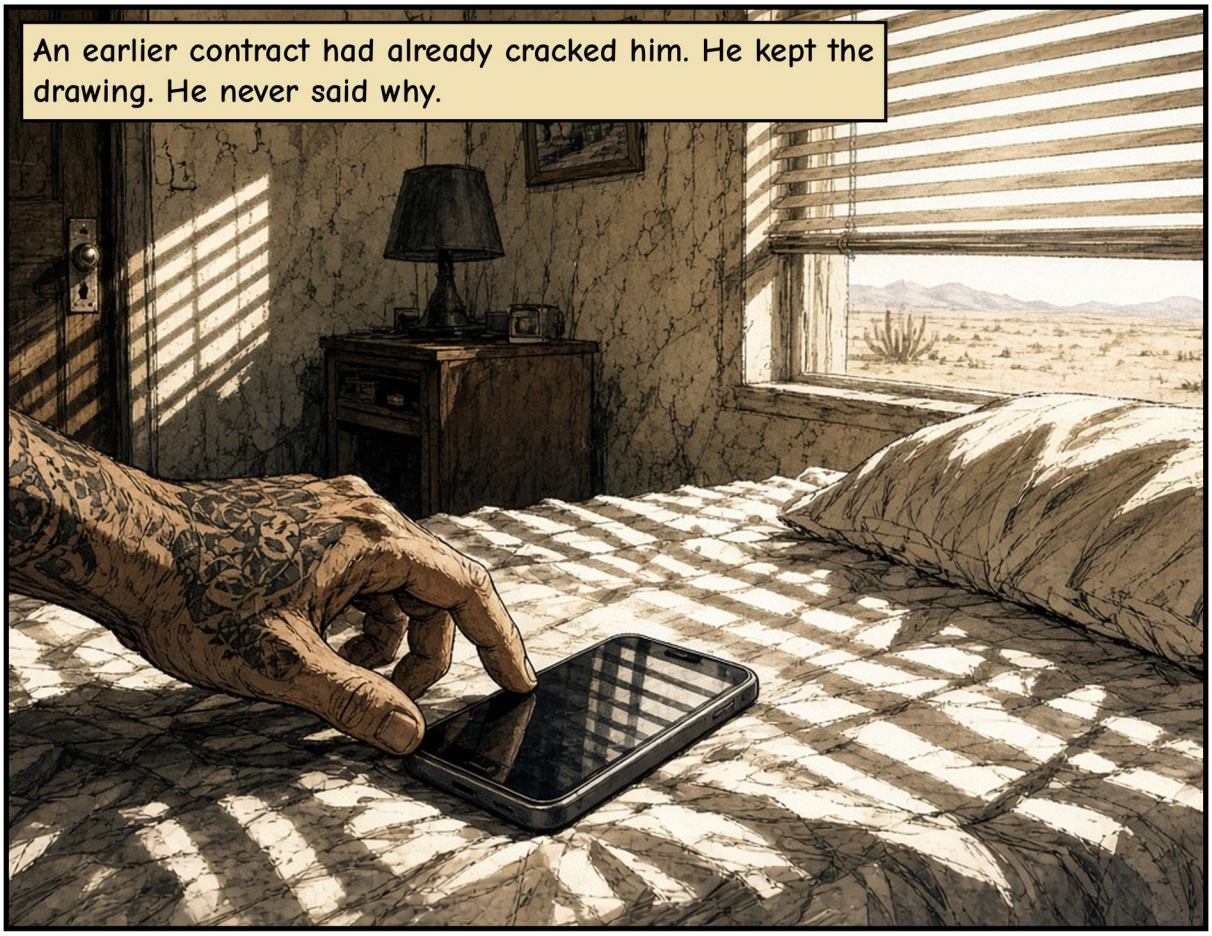
THE LIGHT STAYS ON

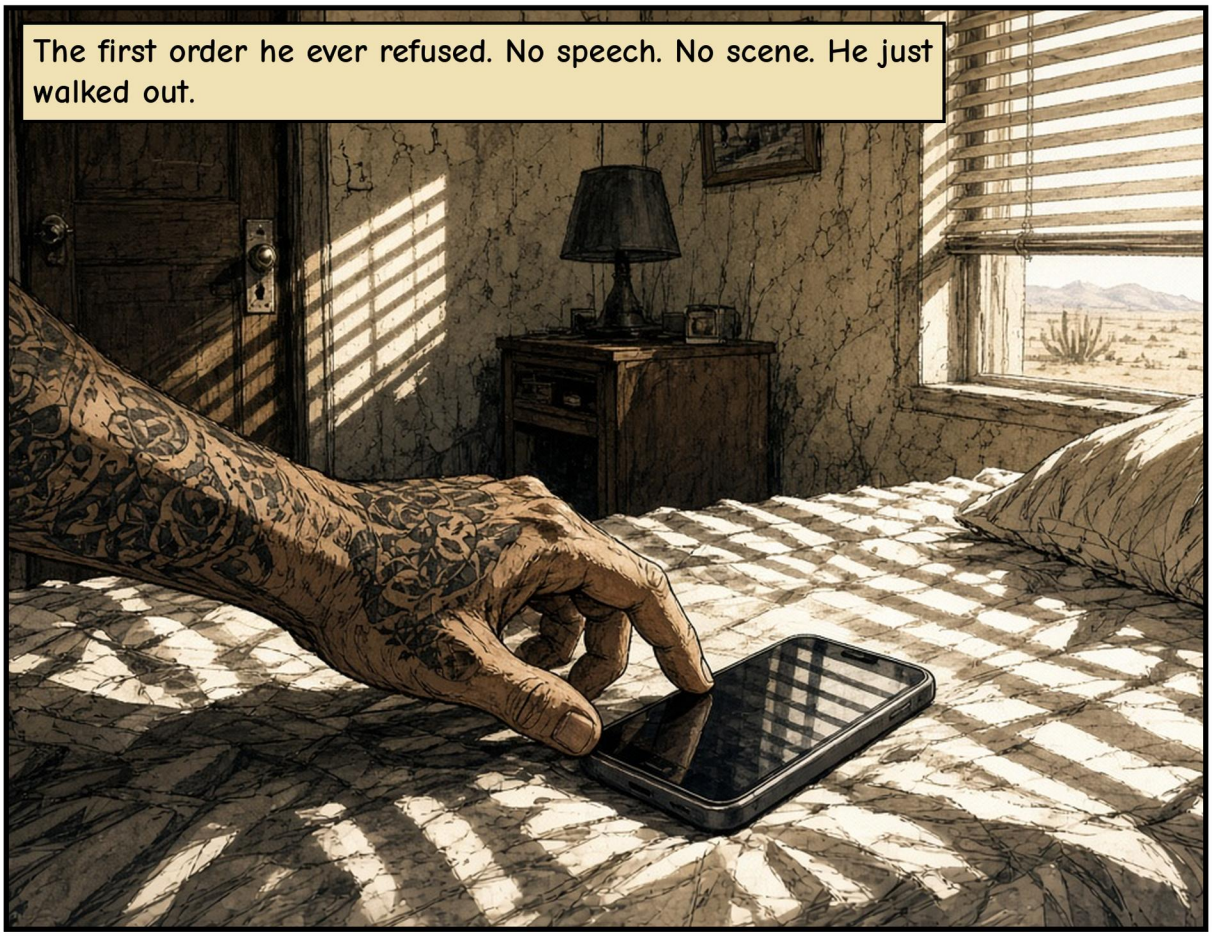


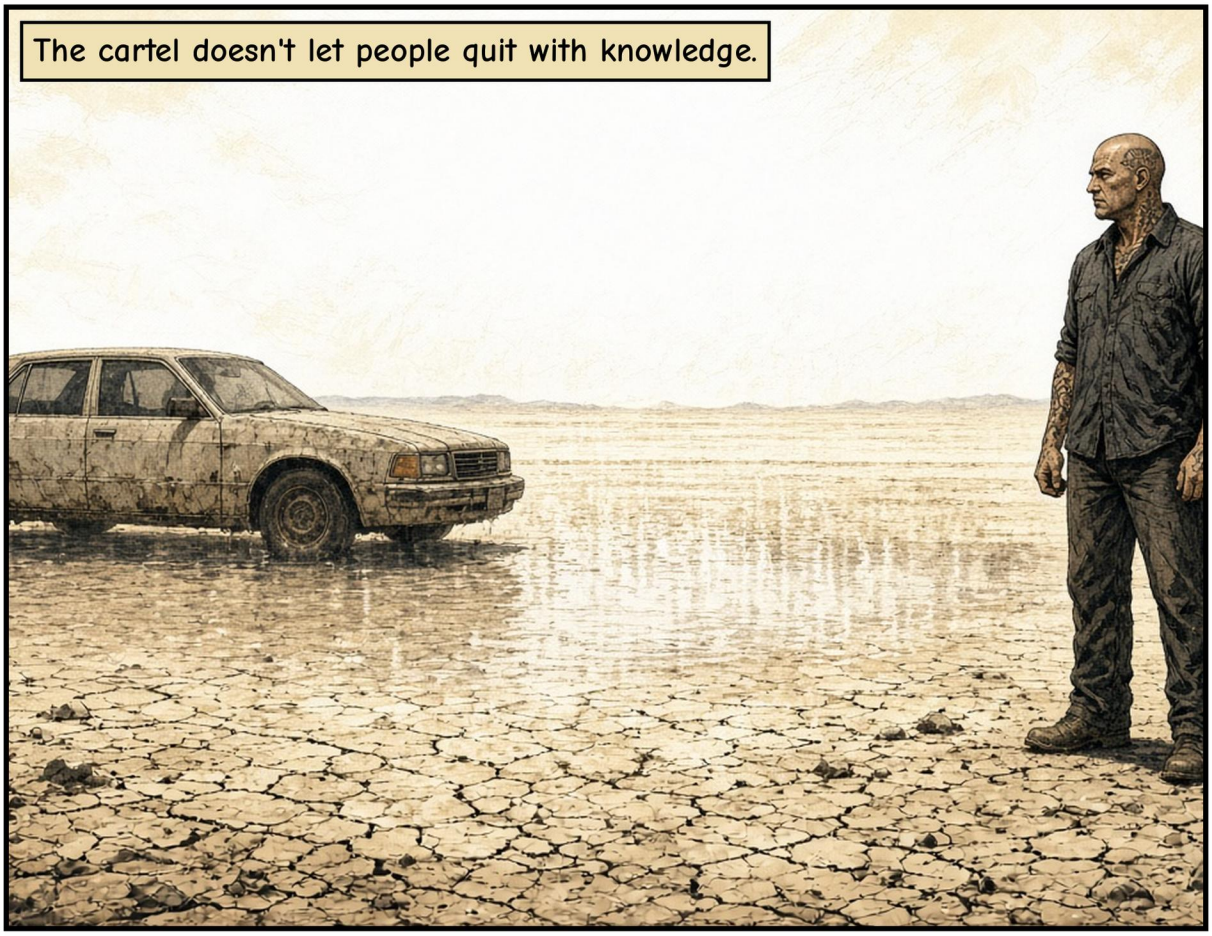
CHAOTIC DESIGNS

ISSUE #1


The order came down the way they all did. No name. No reason. Just a target.
This time the target was a teenage girl.


An earlier contract had already cracked him. He kept the drawing. He never said why.

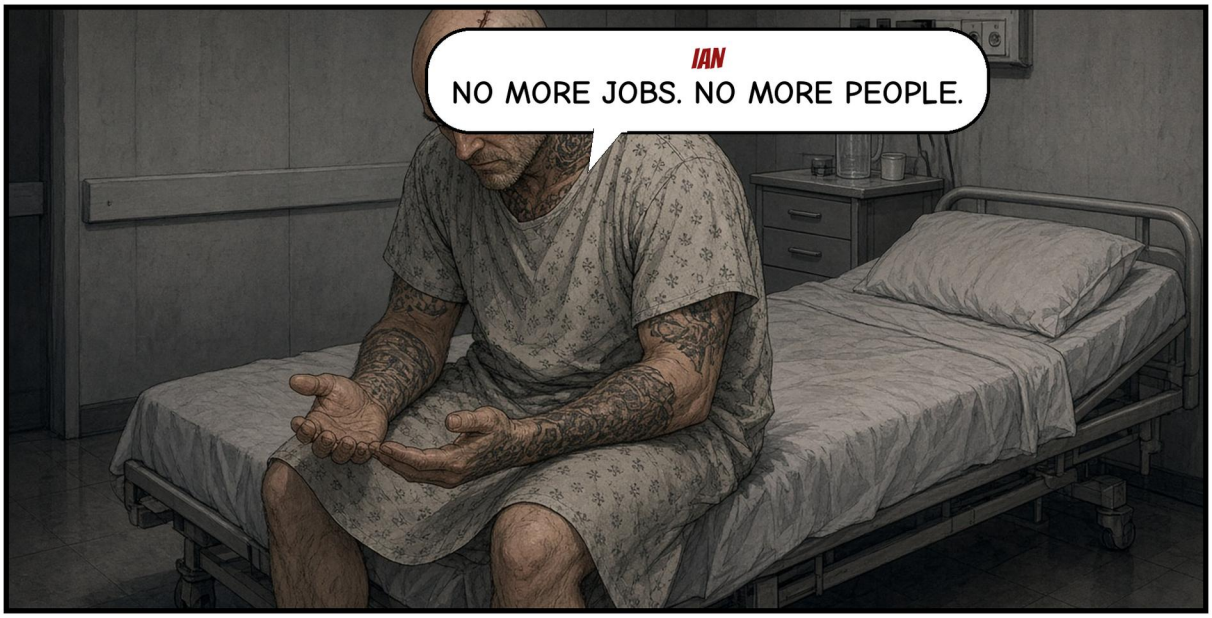

The first order he ever refused. No speech. No scene. He just walked out.

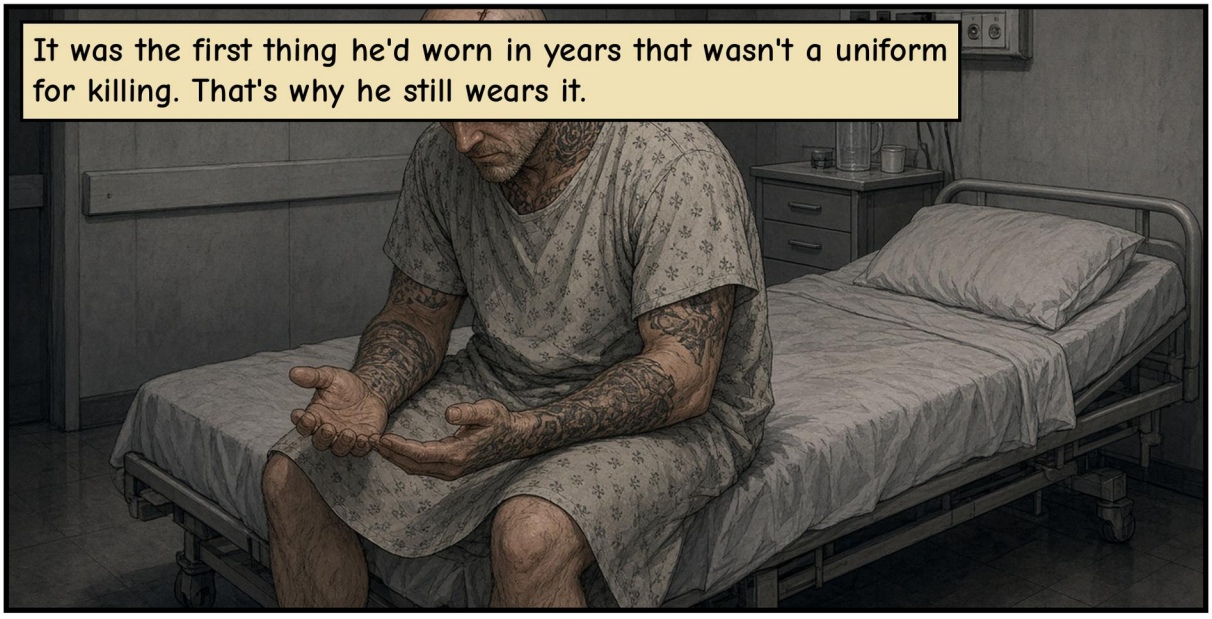

The cartel doesn't let people quit with knowledge.


A shot he never hears. The round carved bone instead of ending him.


VOICE (OFF-PANEL)
LEAVE HIM.


Months. Walking again. Seeing straight. Trusting his hands.


IAN
NO MORE JOBS. NO MORE PEOPLE.


It was the first thing he'd worn in years that wasn't a uniform for killing. That's why he still wears it.


SARA
WHEN WE LEAVE, AND WE ARE LEAVING, WHERE DO WE GO?
IAN
ANYWHERE. I'LL TAKE YOU.


He never did take her. Hold that. It matters at the bridge.


The night the world ended, a stranger held a gate for thirty seconds. It saved Ian's life. He never learned the man's name.


The peninsula was sealed. Everyone inside was written off. Everyone but one woman, holding a refuge together in High Point, and one man who'd made a vow to an empty room, and was about to break it.


TO BE CONTINUED...